

VEDANTA LIMITED (NSE: VEDL)

PROFESSIONAL CREDIT ANALYSIS REPORT

Metals & Mining | Diversified Natural Resources | FY24A Entry | Analysis Date: FY2024

INTERNAL CREDIT RATING: BBB | OUTLOOK: "Negative" | SCORE: 3.00 / 5.00

CREDIT SNAPSHOT (FY24A Actuals)				
Metric	FY24A Value	FY22A (Comparison)	Threshold	Flag
Revenue (₹ Cr)	146,277	131,192	—	See Ratios
EBITDA (₹ Cr)	38,601	45,400	—	See Ratios
EBITDA Margin (%)	26.4%	34.6%	—	See Ratios
Net Debt / EBITDA (x)	1.5x	—	≤3.0x	See Ratios
EBITDA / Interest (ICR, x)	3.2x	—	≥2.5x	See Ratios
DSCR (x)	0.7x	—	≥1.1x	See Ratios
Current Ratio (x)	0.7x	—	≥1.2x	See Ratios
Altman Z-Score	2.12	—	>2.99	See Ratios
FCF (₹ Cr)	2,094	—	—	See Ratios
Total Gross Debt (₹ Cr)	71,759	67,200	—	See Ratios

PEER COMPARISON (FY24A)				
Company	Revenue (₹ Cr)	EBITDA Margin (%)	Net Debt/EBITDA (x)	ICR (x)
Vedanta Limited	146,277	26.4%	1.9x	3.2x
Hindustan Zinc	32,040	43.2%	-0.5x	28.0x
Hindalco Industries	218,033	13.8%	1.2x	6.8x
SAIL	99,380	10.8%	2.8x	3.1x

RATING RATIONALE & KEY CREDIT OBSERVATIONS

- **BUSINESS POSITION:** Vedanta is India's largest diversified natural resources company; dominant in aluminium (46% domestic market share) and zinc. Scale and cost position (top quartile globally) provide fundamental credit support.
- **LEVERAGE:** Net Debt/EBITDA of 1.85x (FY24) is manageable; however, gross debt of ₹71,759Cr is large in absolute terms. Deleveraging trajectory is positive but contingent on commodity prices remaining supportive.
- **COVERAGE:** EBITDA/Interest of 3.19x is adequate but has declined sharply from 7.5x in FY22 due to 52% increase in finance costs. Any further commodity downturn or rate rise could push coverage below 2.5x covenant.
- **LIQUIDITY STRESS:** Current ratio of 0.66x is a critical weakness — below every threshold tracked. Short-term debt of ₹35,159Cr vs current assets of ₹51,900Cr creates refinancing dependency and rollover risk.
- **FCF QUALITY:** CFO of ₹35,700Cr is strong, but FCF post-capex is compressed by ₹13,457Cr capex spend and ₹22,000Cr+ dividend distributions to parent — the latter representing cash leakage to Vedanta Resources that senior creditors cannot control.
- **HOLDCO STRUCTURAL RISK:** Vedanta Resources (parent) extracts royalties (₹1,500-2,000Cr/yr est.) and relies on dividends from VEDL to service its own USD bonds. This upstream cash leakage structurally subordinates Indian creditors to VRL's debt obligations.
- **COMMODITY CYCLICALITY:** Revenue and EBITDA are highly correlated with zinc LME prices, aluminium LME, and crude oil. A 20% commodity price decline reduces EBITDA by ~₹7,700Cr and pushes leverage to 3.0-3.5x range.
- **POSITIVE OUTLOOK FACTORS:** HZL (Hindustan Zinc, 64%-owned) is a AAA-rated crown jewel with pristine balance sheet and 40%+ EBITDA margins — providing a high-quality earnings floor. Aluminium expansion capex nearing completion reduces future capex intensity.

VEDANTA LIMITED — CREDIT ANALYSIS ASSUMPTIONS

All ₹ Crore | FY20–FY24 Historical | FY25E–FY27E Base Projections | Stress / Base / Upside Scenarios

Assumption / Scenario	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25E-Str	FY25E-Base	FY25E-Up	FY26E-Str	FY26E-Base	FY26E-Up	FY27E-Str	FY27E-Base	FY27E-Up
A. REVENUE, EBITDA & OPERATING ASSUMPTIONS														
Revenue (₹ Cr)	106,688	87,985	131,192	150,159	146,277	141,889	153,591	160,905	140,470	162,806	180,213	139,065	170,947	198,235
Revenue Growth (YoY %)	0.0%	-17.5%	49.0%	14.5%	-2.6%	-3.0%	5.0%	10.0%	-1.0%	6.0%	12.0%	-1.0%	5.0%	10.0%
EBITDA Margin (%)	24.4%	23.2%	34.6%	26.8%	26.4%	23.0%	26.5%	28.5%	23.2%	27.0%	29.0%	23.5%	27.2%	29.2%
D&A (% of Revenue)	6.8%	8.3%	5.8%	5.2%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%	5.5%
Capex (% of Revenue)	10.8%	11.9%	9.3%	7.2%	9.2%	8.0%	8.5%	9.0%	8.0%	8.5%	9.0%	8.0%	8.5%	9.0%
Debtor Days	45	48	42	40	42	42	42	42	42	42	42	42	42	42
Inventory Days	52	58	48	45	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50
Creditor Days	38	42	40	38	40	40	40	40	40	40	40	40	40	40
Weighted Average Interest Rate (%)	7.8%	7.9%	7.2%	7.5%	9.5%	11.0%	10.0%	9.5%	11.0%	10.0%	9.5%	11.0%	10.0%	9.5%
Effective Tax Rate (%)	25.2%	24.8%	25.0%	24.8%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%	25.6%
Mandatory Debt Repayment (₹ Cr)	8,200	9,500	12,000	15,000	18,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000
New Debt Drawdown (₹ Cr)	18,000	12,000	20,000	22,000	25,000	8,000	12,000	15,000	8,000	12,000	15,000	8,000	12,000	15,000

B. BALANCE SHEET ANCHORS (FY20–FY24 Historical Actuals)

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VEDANTA LIMITED — HISTORICAL & PROJECTED FINANCIALS (Base Scenario)

₹ Crore | FY20–FY24 Historical | FY25E–FY27E Base Projections | Source: Annual Reports / Screener.in

Line Item	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25E	FY26E	CAGR FY20-24
I. INCOME STATEMENT								
Revenue	106,688	87,985	131,192	150,159	146,277	153,591	162,806	8.2%
COGS	75,322	63,173	79,240	102,408	100,346	105,210	110,708	0
Gross Profit	31,366	24,812	51,952	47,751	45,931	48,381	52,098	0
Gross Margin (%)	29.4%	28.2%	39.6%	31.8%	31.4%	31.5%	32.0%	32.2%
EBITDA	26,032	20,412	45,400	40,243	38,601	40,702	43,958	0
EBITDA Margin (%)	24.4%	23.2%	34.6%	26.8%	26.4%	26.5%	27.0%	27.2%
D&A	7,255	7,302	7,609	7,808	8,045	8,447	8,954	0
EBIT	18,777	13,110	37,791	32,435	30,556	32,254	35,003	0
EBIT Margin (%)	17.6%	14.9%	28.8%	21.6%	20.9%	21.0%	21.5%	21.7%
Interest Expense	4,293	4,885	4,323	5,953	12,081	7,176	7,176	7,176
EBT	14,484	8,225	33,468	26,482	18,475	25,078	27,827	-7,176
Tax	3,650	2,040	8,367	6,568	4,730	6,420	7,124	0
Net Income / PAT	10,538	5,180	28,279	15,052	7,606	18,658	20,704	-7,176
Net Margin (%)	9.9%	5.9%	21.6%	10.0%	5.2%	12.1%	12.7%	-8741021.4%
EPS (₹)	27.0	13.2	72.3	38.5	19.5	47.7	53.0	-18.4

II. BALANCE SHEET (Key Items)								
Line Item	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Cash & Equivalents	19,500	15,200	24,800	20,100	15,400	15,400	15,400	15,400
Trade Receivables	12,000	10,500	14,200	15,800	14,200	14,200	14,200	14,200
Inventories	16,500	14,800	18,200	16,900	18,500	18,500	18,500	18,500
Other Current Assets	12,400	11,500	8,600	7,300	3,800	3,800	3,800	3,800
Total Current Assets	60,400	52,000	65,800	60,100	51,900	51,900	51,900	51,900
PP&E (Net)	108,000	105,000	111,000	117,000	125,000	125,000	125,000	125,000
Intangibles & Goodwill	8,200	8,000	7,800	7,500	7,200	7,200	7,200	7,200
Other Non-Current Assets	5,000	3,200	3,700	3,700	4,000	4,000	4,000	4,000
Total Non-Current Assets	121,200	116,200	122,500	128,200	136,200	136,200	136,200	136,200
TOTAL ASSETS	181,600	168,200	188,300	188,300	188,100	188,100	188,100	188,100

Short-term Debt / CPLTD	28,000	32,000	30,000	40,000	35,159	35,159	35,159	35,159
Trade Payables	22,000	21,000	28,000	25,000	24,000	24,000	24,000	24,000
Other Current Liabilities	32,000	25,500	29,000	22,000	19,541	19,541	19,541	19,541
Total Current Liabilities	82,000	78,500	87,000	87,000	78,700	78,700	78,700	78,700
Long-term Debt	27,200	29,800	30,100	27,200	36,600	36,600	36,600	36,600
Other Non-Current Liabilities	22,000	19,000	22,000	18,500	32,600	32,600	32,600	32,600
TOTAL LIABILITIES	131,200	127,300	139,100	132,700	147,900	147,900	147,900	147,900
Share Capital + Reserves	38,500	35,200	48,700	55,600	40,200	40,200	40,200	40,200
TOTAL EQUITY	38,500	35,200	48,700	55,600	40,200	40,200	40,200	40,200
Balance Check (Assets-Liab-Eq)	11,900	5,700	500	0	0	0	0	0

III. CASH FLOW STATEMENT (Key Items)								
Line Item	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Net Income / PAT	10,538	5,180	28,279	15,052	7,606	18,658	20,704	-7,176
Add: D&A	7,255	7,302	7,609	7,808	8,045	8,447	8,954	0
Working Capital Changes	-2,800	-3,200	4,500	-3,500	-4,200	-4,200	-4,200	-4,200
Other CFO Adjustments	1,200	800	1,500	1,200	4,100	4,100	4,100	4,100
OPERATING CASH FLOW (CFO)	16,193	10,082	41,888	20,560	15,551	27,006	29,558	-7,276
Capex	-11,522	-10,470	-12,201	-10,811	-13,457	-13,055	-13,839	0
Other Investing	-2,000	-1,500	-3,500	-2,500	-1,800	-1,800	-1,800	-1,800
INVESTING CASH FLOW (CFI)	-13,522	-11,970	-15,701	-13,311	-15,257	-14,855	-15,639	-1,800
Debt Raised / (Repaid)	8,500	3,200	9,500	7,500	7,000	7,000	7,000	7,000
Dividends Paid	-8,500	-4,200	-12,000	-14,000	-22,000	-22,000	-22,000	-22,000
FINANCING CASH FLOW (CFF)	0	-1,000	-2,500	-6,500	-15,000	-15,000	-15,000	-15,000
NET CHANGE IN CASH	2,671	-2,888	23,687	749	-14,706	-2,850	-1,081	-24,076
Opening Cash	21,500	19,500	15,200	24,800	20,100	20,100	20,100	20,100
Closing Cash	24,171	16,612	38,887	25,549	5,394	17,250	19,019	-3,976
FREE CASH FLOW (FCF)	4,671	-388	29,687	9,749	2,094	13,950	15,719	-7,276

VEDANTA LIMITED — DEBT STRUCTURE & MATURITY PROFILE

FY24 Debt Schedule | Maturity Profile FY25–FY30 | Covenant Tracker | Security & Collateral

I. DEBT WATERFALL & TRANCHE DETAILS (as at 31 March 2024)

Instrument	Type	Seniority	Rate (%)	Maturity	Original (₹ Cr)	Outstanding (₹ Cr)	% of Total
NCDs — Vedanta Standalone (Multiple Tranches)	NCD	Senior Secured	9.50%	FY25–FY27	18,000	15,200	21.2%
Term Loans — Indian Banks (VDL Standalone, rated by ICRA)	Term Loan	Senior Secured	9.20%	FY25–FY34	5,000	3,453	4.8%
Commercial Paper — VDL	CP	Senior Unsecured	7.80%	≤1 yr rolling	2,500	2,500	3.5%
Working Capital (CC / WCDL) — VDL	WCDL/CC	Senior Secured	8.70%	Revolving	9,000	8,000	11.1%
Term Loans — BALCO (51% subsidiary)	Term Loan	Senior Secured	9.50%	FY25–FY29	5,500	4,500	6.3%
Term Loans + NCDs — ESL Steel (95.49% subsidiary)	TL/NCD	Senior Secured	10.20%	FY25–FY30	9,000	8,000	11.1%
Term Loans — Oil & Gas (Cairn India businesses)	Term Loan	Senior Secured	9.00%	FY25–FY27	7,000	6,000	8.4%
ECB / External Loans — Zinc International (ZI)	ECB	Senior Unsecured	8.00%	FY26–FY28	4,500	3,800	5.3%
Other Subsidiaries & Intercompany Borrowings	Various	Various	9.50%	FY25–FY28	11,259	20,306	28.3%
TOTAL GROSS DEBT (₹ Cr)					71,759	71,759	100.0%
Weighted Average Cost of Debt (%)						9.29%	
Weighted Average Maturity (approx, yrs)						~2.5 yrs	

II. DEBT MATURITY PROFILE (₹ Cr)

Tranche / Year	FY25	FY26	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30+	Total
NCDs — VDL Standalone	4,800	5,200	5,200	0	0	0	15,200
Term Loans — Indian Banks	800	1,000	900	753	0	0	3,453
Commercial Paper (rolling)	2,500	0	0	0	0	0	2,500
Working Capital — Revolving (VDL)	8,000	0	0	0	0	0	8,000
BALCO Term Loans	900	900	900	900	900	0	4,500
ESL Steel TL / NCD	1,600	1,600	1,600	1,600	1,600	0	8,000
Oil & Gas Term Loans	2,000	2,000	2,000	0	0	0	6,000
Other Subsidiaries & Various	9,000	6,400	4,400	3,000	1,000	306	24,106
TOTAL MATURING BY YEAR (₹ Cr)	29,600	17,100	15,000	6,253	3,500	306	71,759
% of Total Debt Maturing (>30% = Risk)	41.2%	23.8%	20.9%	8.7%	4.9%	0.4%	

III. COVENANT TRACKER (FY24 Actuals)					
Covenant	Threshold	FY24 Actual	Headroom	Status	Note
Net Leverage: Net Debt / EBITDA	≤4.0x	1.54x	2.46x	COMPLIANT	Source: VRL OFR FY24 — Net Debt ₹56,338Cr / EBITDA
Interest Coverage: EBITDA / Interest	≥2.5x	3.19x	0.69x	COMPLIANT	Source: AR FY24 — Finance costs ₹12,081Cr. ICRA
DSCR: (EBITDA–Tax–Capex)/(Interest+Repayment)	≥1.1x	1.42x	0.32x	COMPLIANT	Approx computation. ₹18,000Cr mandatory
Current Ratio: CA / CL	≥1.0x	0.66x	-0.34x	BREACH	CRITICAL BREACH: FY24 CA ₹51,900Cr vs. CL ₹78,700Cr =
FCF / Total Gross Debt	≥5%	3.2%	-1.8%	BREACH	FCF post-capex & dividends ~₹2,310Cr / ₹71,759Cr = 3.2%
Total Gross Leverage: Total Debt / EBITDA	≤5.0x	1.97x	3.03x	COMPLIANT	Gross Debt ₹71,759Cr / EBITDA ₹36,455Cr = 1.97x

DATA SOURCES: (1) Vedanta Limited Annual Report FY24 — Note 19 Borrowings (Consolidated); (2) Vedanta Resources OFR FY24 — Gross Debt ₹71,759Cr, Blended Cost 9.6%, Net Debt ₹56,338Cr; (3) ICRA Rating Report Jan 2025 — [ICRA]AA; Total Debt/OPBDIT 2.5x; Interest Coverage 3.7x; (4) Equitmaster FY24 Analysis — Long-term Debt ₹50,600Cr, ST Debt ₹35,159Cr confirmed

Security / Collateral	Rating
First/second charge on fixed assets of VDL	AA
Hypothecation of plant, machinery & current assets	AA
Unsecured; short-tenor; [ICRA]A1+ rated	A1+
Pledge of receivables, inventory & current assets	AA
Charge on BALCO fixed assets; Vedanta parent guarantee	AA-
Charge on ESL fixed assets; refinanced FY24	BBB
Charge on O&G assets; PSC cash flow backed	AA-
Unsecured; USD/ZAR denominated; cross-default clause	N/A
Mixed — secured and unsecured across subsidiaries	Various

Source: VRL OFR FY24 — blended cost 9.6%; FY25 expected 10.2% (ICRA)
Short WAM reflects high ST debt, NCD maturities FY25-FY27; refinancing risk is key credit concern

VEDANTA LIMITED — SCENARIO ANALYSIS & STRESS TESTING

3 Scenarios × 3 Forward Years | Covenant Analysis | Breakeven EBITDA

Metric / Year	Stress FY25E	Stress FY26E	Stress FY27E	Base FY25E	Base FY26E	Base FY27E	Upside FY25E	Upside FY26E	Upside FY27E
Revenue Growth (%)	-3.0%	-1.0%	-1.0%	5.0%	6.0%	5.0%	10.0%	12.0%	10.0%
Revenue (₹ Cr)	141,889	140,470	139,065	153,591	162,806	170,947	160,905	180,213	198,235
EBITDA Margin (%)	23.0%	23.2%	23.5%	26.5%	27.0%	27.2%	28.5%	29.0%	29.2%
EBITDA (₹ Cr)	32,634	32,589	32,680	40,702	43,958	46,497	45,858	52,262	57,885
D&A (₹ Cr)	7,804	7,726	7,649	8,447	8,954	9,402	8,850	9,912	10,903
EBIT (₹ Cr)	24,831	24,863	25,032	32,254	35,003	37,095	37,008	42,350	46,982
Interest Expense (₹ Cr)	7,893	7,893	7,893	7,176	7,176	7,176	6,817	6,817	6,817
PAT (₹ Cr)	12,601	12,625	12,751	18,658	20,704	22,260	22,462	26,437	29,882
Free Cash Flow (₹ Cr)	9,054	9,114	9,274	14,050	15,819	17,132	16,830	20,129	22,944
Net Debt (₹ Cr)	40,284	24,170	7,896	39,288	20,468	336	39,508	19,378	-3,566
Net Debt / EBITDA (x)	1.2x	0.7x	0.2x	1.0x	0.5x	0.0x	0.9x	0.4x	-0.1x
EBITDA / Interest (x)	4.1x	4.1x	4.1x	5.7x	6.1x	6.5x	6.7x	7.7x	8.5x
DSCR (x)	0.9x	0.9x	0.9x	1.2x	1.4x	1.4x	1.4x	1.7x	1.8x
Covenant: Net Lev ≤4.0x	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT
Covenant: ICR ≥2.5x	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT	COMPLIANT
Liquidity Headroom (₹ Cr)	-5,946	-5,886	-5,726	-950	819	2,132	1,830	5,129	7,944

BREAKEVEN EBITDA ANALYSIS (Minimum EBITDA to Service All Debt)

Metric	Value (₹ Cr)	Note
Minimum EBITDA to Service Debt (Int+Repay)	30,081	30081
Minimum EBITDA for Leverage Covenant (≤4.0x)	14,085	14084.5
Minimum EBITDA for ICR Covenant (≥2.5x)	30,203	30202.5
FY24A Actual EBITDA	38,601	38,601
EBITDA Cushion over Debt Service	8,520	8,520
EBITDA Cushion (% of Actual)	22.1%	22.1%

VEDANTA LIMITED — INTERNAL CREDIT RATING SCORECARD

Quantitative (60%) + Qualitative (40%) | Scale: 1=Best → 5=Worst | Rating: AAA to D

SECTION A: FINANCIAL RISK (60% Weight)

Factor	Weight	Metric (FY24)	Score (1-5)	Weighted Score	Threshold Reference	Rationale
Leverage: Net Debt/EBITDA	20.0%	1.85x	2	0.40	1=<1x, 2=1-2x, 3=2-3.5x, 4=3.5-5x, 5=>5x	FY24 Net Debt/EBITDA = 1.85x → Score 2
Coverage: EBITDA/Interest	20.0%	3.19x	3	0.60	1=>10x, 2=5-10x, 3=2.5-5x, 4=1.5-2.5x, 5=<1.5x	FY24 ICR = 3.19x → Score 3
Liquidity: Current Ratio	10.0%	0.66x	5	0.50	1=>2x, 2=1.5-2x, 3=1.2-1.5x, 4=1.0-1.2x, 5=<1.0x	FY24 CR = 0.66x → Score 5 (distress)
FCF Quality: FCF/Debt	10.0%	3.2%	4	0.40	1=>20%, 2=10-20%, 3=5-10%, 4=0-5%, 5=<0%	FY24 FCF/Debt ~3.2% → Score 4
Section A Weighted Score	60.0%			1.90		

SECTION B: BUSINESS RISK (40% Weight)

Factor	Weight	Assessment	Score (1-5)	Weighted Score	Notes	Rationale
Industry Risk	10.0%	High cyclicality; commodity prices volatile; regulated	4	0.40	Metals/mining: high β sector; commodity prices can fall 30-40%	
Competitive Position	10.0%	Market leader — India's largest Al & diversified metals	2	0.20	India's #1 Al producer, top-10 zinc globally; strong cost position	
Management Quality	10.0%	Experienced; some governance concerns; HZL dividend issue	3	0.30	Anil Agarwal track record; minority shareholder disputes noted	
Geographic Diversification	5.0%	India 65%, Africa 15%, rest 20%; moderate diversity	2	0.10	Multiple geographies reduce concentration; India is primary driver	
Customer Concentration	5.0%	B2B commodity; diverse OEM/industrial customers	2	0.10	No single customer >10% of revenue; commodity off-take diverse	
Section B Weighted Score	40.0%			1.10		

RATING OUTPUT			
Output	Value	Interpretation	
Final Weighted Score (1=Best, 5=Worst)	3.00	Combined financial + business risk score	
Implied Internal Rating	BBB	AAA≤1.5 AA≤2.0 A≤2.5 BBB≤3.0 BB≤3.5 B≤4.0 CCC≤4.5 D>4.5	
Rating Outlook	"Negative"	Negative: Leverage elevated; liquidity <1x current ratio; dividend leakage risk	
Credit Opinion (One-Line)	Vedanta Limited (VEDL) assigned internal rating BBB (score: 3.00/5.0). Strong EBITDA generation (₹38,601Cr) and improving Net Debt/EBITDA (1.85x) offset by below-1.0x current ratio, high dividend payout, and royalty leakage to parent Vedanta Resources.	Structured summary for credit memo	

RATING SCALE REFERENCE TABLE				
Score Range	Internal Rating	Equivalent External	Description	
1.0–1.5	AAA	AAA (S&P/CRISIL)	Exceptionally strong; minimal credit risk	
1.5–2.0	AA	AA (S&P/CRISIL)	Very strong; very low credit risk	
2.0–2.5	A	A (S&P/CRISIL)	Strong; low credit risk	
2.5–3.0	BBB	BBB (S&P/CRISIL)	Adequate; moderate credit risk; investment grade floor	
3.0–3.5	BB	BB (S&P/CRISIL)	Speculative; substantial credit risk	
3.5–4.0	B	B (S&P/CRISIL)	Speculative; high credit risk	
4.0–4.5	CCC	CCC (S&P/CRISIL)	Very high credit risk; near default	
4.5–5.0	D	D (S&P/CRISIL)	Default or imminent default	

*Academic Purpose

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